

INDEPENDENT NIGHT DESK / 2026 EDITION

NIGHT COMPASS JAPAN

THREE-CITY FIRST NIGHT PACK

Tokyo / Nagoya / Hamamatsu



SOURCE-CHECKED. STREET-READY. NO FAKE INSIDER TALK.

01 / START HERE

USE THIS PACK

A short operating manual for your first night in each city.

WHAT THIS GUIDE DOES

This pack turns official police, tourism and transport information into decisions you can use before entering a venue, ordering a drink or committing to the trip home. It does not certify individual businesses as permanently safe.

THE FOUR-STEP LOOP

- Choose the district before you start drinking.
- Choose the venue yourself - never surrender that decision to a tout or a brand-new match.
- Confirm the full price before the first order.
- Decide the route home before the final round.

SAVE THESE NOW

110 POLICE**119 FIRE / AMBULANCE**

JNTO Visitor Hotline: +81 50 3816 2787

Available 24/7 in English, Chinese and Korean.

02 / TOKYO

THE FAST NIGHT

Shinjuku gives you more choice and more pressure. Slow the decision down.

THE TOKYO RULE

You choose the venue, you understand the price, and you keep your card in your possession. A friendly street approach or fluent English does not change that rule.

FOUR CHECKS BEFORE ENTRY

- Did you find the venue independently?
- Are table charge, tax, service fee and time limit clear?
- Is a new online match insisting on this exact bar?
- Can you name your route home and emergency option?



IF THE BILL LOOKS WRONG

Ask for an itemized bill. Do not hand over your card while the amount is unclear. If you feel threatened or prevented from leaving, call 110 or move toward a koban police box.

USEFUL PHRASE

Zenbu de ikura desu ka?

How much is it in total?

03 / NAGOYA

THE FOOD-FIRST NIGHT

One district and one good meal make a stronger start than a list of famous bars.

PICK ONE ANCHOR

Nagoya Station works when your hotel or onward train is nearby. Sakae and Fushimi work when you want a denser evening district and an easier walk to a second stop.

LET FOOD SET THE PACE

Start with a menu-led izakaya and a local dish. Confirm otoshi or table charge, tax, service and last-order time. Add a second venue only after the first one has given you a clear read on the night.



READ THE ROOM

- A small counter can be welcoming without being suited to a large group.
- Look for a visible menu, open seats and a clear greeting from staff.
- If the system cannot be explained, leave politely before ordering.
- Keep the exact hotel address saved in Japanese for the return trip.

04 / HAMAMATSU

THE LOCAL-RHYTHM NIGHT

Stay close, listen first and decide the ride home before the final drink.

USE TWO STATION PINS

Save Hamamatsu Station and Shin-Hamamatsu Station separately. They serve different rail systems. Treat them as the anchor for Act City, the central streets and Yurakugai.

USE THE CITY'S IDENTITY

Hamamatsu is Japan's City of Music. Look for current live performance schedules and small music-led venues, but verify each event and admission rule directly on the day.



BEFORE ANOTHER ROUND

- Check the current Enshu Railway timetable, not a copied time.
- Keep voices aligned with the room and ask before moving seats.
- Do not tip; pay the stated bill and thank the staff.
- Choose a taxi while your phone still has battery and your destination is clear.

05 / VENUE CHECK

THE 60-SECOND DOOR TEST

Fill these gaps before the first order. A vague answer is useful information.

01 VENUE NAME

Can I match the sign, map listing and entrance?

02 TABLE CHARGE

Is there an otoshi, cover or seating fee?

03 TIME

Is there a time limit and when is last order?

04 TOTAL PRICE

Does the listed price include tax and service?

05 PAYMENT

Which methods are accepted and do I keep my card?

06 EXIT

Can I leave freely and do I know the route home?

TWO PHRASES WORTH SAVING

Sekiryo wa arimasu ka? - Is there a table charge?

Meisai o kudasai. - Please give me an itemized bill.

06 / RETURN PLAN

LEAVE BEFORE THE DECISION GETS HARD

The route home is part of the night, not an administrative detail at closing time.

BEFORE THE SECOND VENUE

- Check the exact-date last train or subway connection.
- Save the accommodation name, address and nearest entrance in Japanese.
- Keep a taxi option and a payment backup.
- Set a battery floor: leave while navigation and calls are still reliable.

PAYMENT CONTROL

- Photograph the displayed price list when charges are complex.
- Do not let a stranger choose your ATM or handle your card.
- Ask for the total before agreeing to another time block or drink plan.
- If pressure rises, prioritize a safe exit over winning the argument inside.

YOUR EXIT PLAN IS A SAFETY TOOL.

Make it while the night is still easy.

07 / SOURCES

VERIFY BEFORE YOU GO

Open these official pages for current operating, safety and visitor information.

TOKYO

Tokyo Metropolitan Police - nightlife crime prevention

JNTO - emergencies and visitor support

NAGOYA

Visit Nagoya - Japanese pubs and bars

Aichi Prefectural Police - English information

HAMAMATSU

Hamamatsu official tourism - City of Music

Hamamatsu City - travel etiquette

Enshu Railway - English guide

Shizuoka Prefectural Police - languages

IMPORTANT

Venue ownership, prices, schedules and local conditions can change. This guide provides decision tools, not a guarantee that any individual business or route is safe. In an emergency, contact the responsible public authority.